

1,000 REAL INDIE STARTUPS · TRUSTMRR DATA · FROZEN JUL 30, 2026

Boring Builds **Business.**

Everyone's piling into AI. Turns out the money's mostly showing up somewhere else, at least for now.

197

startups building in AI right now,
more than any other category

\$446

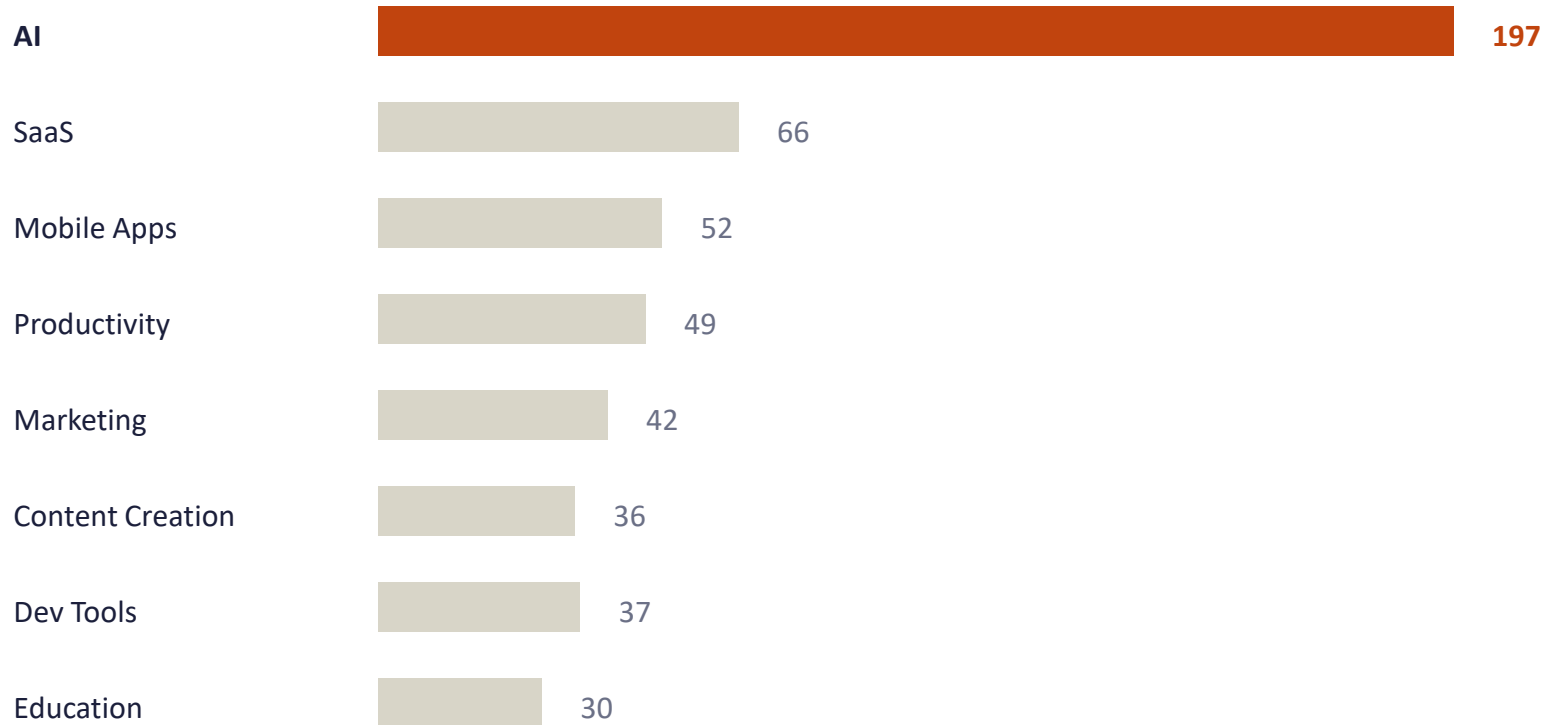
and that's their median
monthly revenue

\$2,142

meanwhile Education's
median MRR

WHERE EVERYONE'S BUILDING

The crowd picked **AI**.



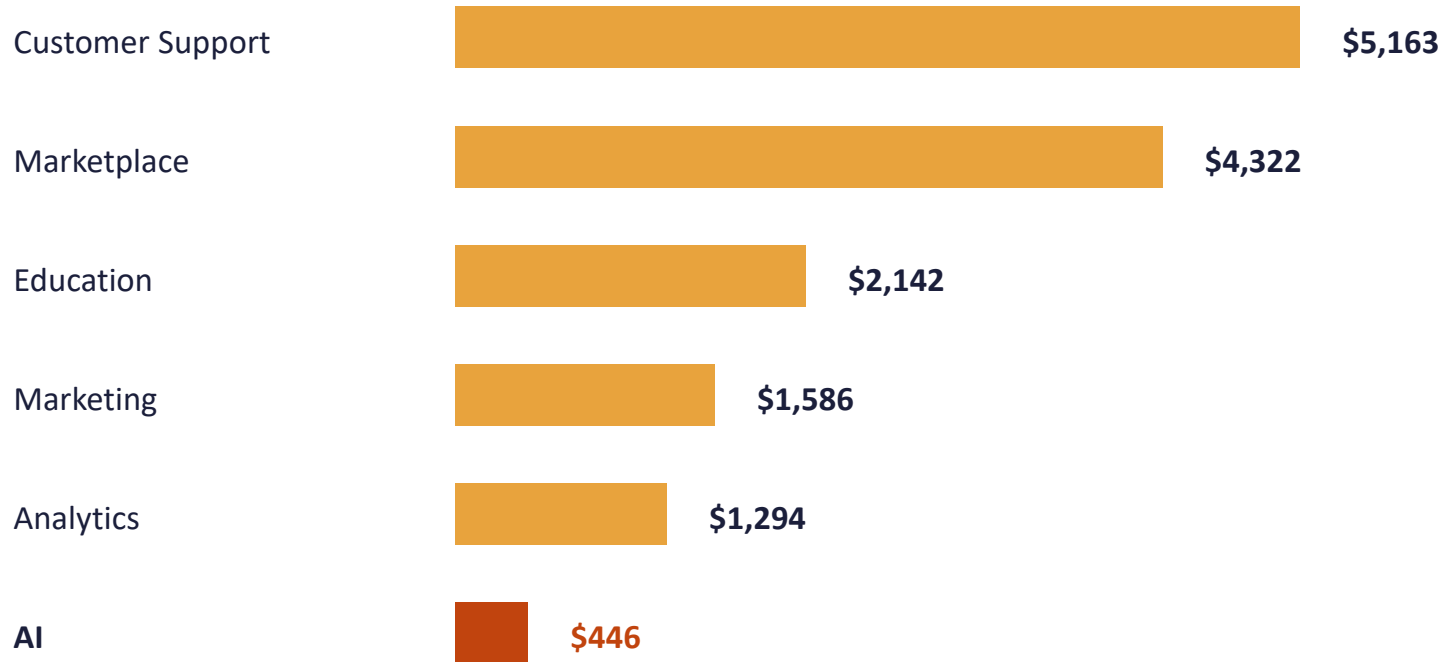
1 in 5

startups in this dataset are building in AI, nearly 3x the next biggest category.

Right now it's the single most crowded bet an indie builder can make.

WHERE THE REVENUE SHOWS UP

But not the money.



Median monthly recurring revenue per startup, by category

Source: TrustMRR, n = 1,000 revenue-verified startups

5.7×

more revenue for B2B startups than B2C, \$1,036 vs \$181 median MRR.

AI's median MRR is lower than Fintech, Social Media, Content, Analytics, Marketing, even Education.

SO WHAT DO YOU DO WITH THIS

The bet isn't wrong. It's early.

AI's ceiling is real, nobody's arguing that. It just isn't paying out yet at the indie level. Right now the actual money's sitting in unglamorous, B2B, underbuilt categories.

1

Build boring, build B2B

B2B pays way more, 5.7x the median of B2C.

2

Skip the crowded trade

AI's got roughly 3x the builders of the next category chasing below-median returns.

3

Treat AI as R&D, not this quarter's revenue plan

Circle back once monetization actually catches up with the hype.